

Extended chords

Chords can have added notes beyond a seventh note—for example, notes that are a ninth, an eleventh, or a thirteenth above the root of a chord can be added to it. These notes would be indicated by the numbers 9, 11, and 13 respectively in chord symbols, as shown below.

Ninth chord	Chord name + 9
Eleventh chord	Chord name + 11
Thirteenth chord	Chord name + 13

Dominant seventh chord with an added ninth = D9.



△ **D9**

The dominant seventh chord starting on D, with an added ninth, has the chord symbol D9.

D major seventh chord with an added ninth = Dmaj9.



△ **Dmaj9**

This D major seventh chord with an added ninth has the chord symbol Dmaj9.

Tone chords

Those chords where a particular note has been raised or lowered by a half step are known as tone chords. The chord symbol includes an indication as to which note has been altered, and whether it has been raised or lowered. For example, the symbol (♭5) shows that the fifth of a chord has been lowered.

Raised note	Chord name + sharp symbol (#, +, Δ) before the altered tone of the chord
Lowered note	Chord name + flat symbol (♭, or -) before the altered tone of the chord



△ **GM7(♭5)**

The symbol for this chord is GM7(♭5) as it is a GM7 chord with the altered tone of a lowered fifth, D♭.

Fifth of the chord is lowered from D to D♭.

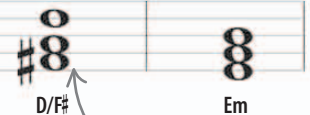
Slash chord

A slash chord has a bass note that is not the root of the chord. Its chord symbol is indicated by the root note, a slash, and then the bass note. The bass note can belong to the chord (in which case the slash chord is an inversion), but this is not always the case.

Symbol	Chord	Bass note
C/G	C major	G (a C major second inversion)
D/F#	D major	F# (a D major first inversion)
Am/G	A minor	G



G



D/F#

Em

△ **Slash chords in practice**

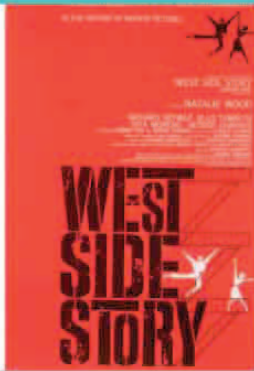
The slash chord D/F# is used so that the bass line can move down from G to F#, and then to E.

The bass note of D/F# chord is F#

REAL WORLD

Blues harmonies

What makes the blues blue? The 12-bar blues is built on a I-IV-V progression that flattens the fifth, giving a kink to what would otherwise be a straightforward major chord pattern. This means that blues music uses lots of diminished chord symbols. Leonard Bernstein's *West Side Story* is heavily influenced by jazz, and it features many blues harmonies.



No one knows who invented chord symbols, but some musicologists believe they were first used by the American composer, arranger, and pianist Ferde Grofé (1892–1972).